

The Shrine Where Death Paused Family and Relationships

Rules (Not all but noteworthy):

1. Nothing operates in the estate without Sukuna
2. Women stay untouched till partnered (because Leora was untouched when she gave herself to Sukuna and because he is not going to let anyone near his daughter unless she's sure that's who she wants permanently.)
3. Women never leave the estate for marriage. If someone asks to court and marry a woman from the estate, they come to the estate. Sukuna does not allow any of his women to leave unless chaperoned by himself or someone trusted and he does not permit them to move unless he decides much later.

Main pair and focus of the story:

Leora and Sukuna

Romantic Relationships

1. Leora and Sukuna (married but it transcends the definition)
2. Chobei and Tsukihiko (Performed devouring vow which is stronger than marriage)
3. Friedhelm and Sukuna (lovers)
4. Chobei and Leora (lovers)
5. Kurohiko and Kiyomi (Just now married)
6. Kaguya and Toma (married)
7. Mizuki and Kyrr (Just completed the Devouring Vow/Married)

Special Bonds

1. Friedhelm and Tsukihiko are mentor and pupil, uncle and nephew, the-son-Friedhelm-never-had, and a precious bond above all others.
 - a. Not sexual ever
 - b. Not romantic
2. Friedhelm and Sukuna are counter weights in a system. Sukuna respects him now, sometimes if threatened and jealous of him, but ultimately is realizing he loves him (not the same way as Ilora) and he wants him to have a relationship with someone and not be alone (even though that will complicate Sukuna's relationship and access to Friedhelm)
 - a. Sexual now
 - b. Deeply emotional
 - c. Healing for Friedhelm and reflective for Sukuna
 - d. Not fully romantic but there are definitely snatches here and there
 - e. Friedhelm has admitted he does not want a partner because the only two men he has ever and can ever love are Sukuna and Wulf Gegner

- f. Performed the Devouring Vow with Wulf Gegner without Leora knowing when they were in their late teens/early twenties.
- 3. Toma and Chobei are brothers that are extremely close. They are committed to each other in a deep way that they would give up immortality for the other. Chobei feels guilty more and more for the pain Toma has experienced in life. He now blames himself for it all. Toma doesn't want him to but it's easier said than done.
 - a. Chobei cut his own eye when they were abducted by bandits as children in order to save Toma from being raped and sold.
 - b. He said he gave them something more interesting to look at.
 - c. After that, every facial scar Chobei has is a result of someone touching Toma or trying to do something to him and Chobei would hurt himself to draw their attention.
 - d. Toma still feels guilty about it.
- 4. Chōbei and Tsukihiko are soulmates, extremely physically and emotionally intimate, highly affectionate, and are now bound by the devouring vow making their connection permanent even in death.
- 5. Toma and Leora have an adopted son sort of relationship.
 - a. Because of how Toma feels about Chobei, Leora sees herself in that. Friedhelm is her everything and when she met Toma and saw how he reacted when he reunited with Chobei, she approached him, held him, let him sob in her arms, and she told everyone in the family that Toma was to never ever be tested, challenged, pushed, pulled, anything. He was sacred and hers.
 - b. Toma reacts to Leora's fussing, fretting, and managing just as a son would. He becomes brighter and more confident around her.
 - c. Her love brings out in him what Chobei has always wished he could protect and tried to protect.
 - d. Now, Toma is the father of her first granddaughter, Linnea, and she adores him even more.
 - e. Toma is the type of masculinity she will allow freely to exist around her daughter and other women in the family.
- 6. Chobei and Leora
 - a. Started off with Chobei flirting with her and getting into trouble
 - b. Chobei has stated repeatedly she's the most beautiful woman in the world to have ever existed.
 - c. He has declared often and publicly she is the perfect woman.
 - d. One look from her and he's ruined
 - e. He admires her, respects her, and trusts her completely.
 - f. When he wasn't flirting with her, he was receiving maternal love and affection from her that he had never received before. She's the closest thing to a mother he's ever known.

- g. She fed him, fussed over him, gave him purpose, shared with him, and made a place for him in the family.
- h. Eventually, she placed him under her protection when her sons wouldn't stop pushing him trying to make him leave or break.
- i. He took her pain for her physically when she was being hurt.
- j. He instinctively positions himself in rooms to protect her. If Tsukihiko is present, too, he finds a way to push them towards the safest, more defensible part.
- k. He believes perfection like Tsukihiko can only come from perfection.
- l. He asked Leora when he first met her if she needed help. She asked help for what? He said come on, look at you. Look at him. I don't get it. She said get what? He scoffed and said, did he kidnap you? Because, that's the only way it makes sense that you'd be with him. That's okay, I can help you leave if you want to. (A recurring theme in a lot of ways because people do believe sukuna kidnapped her and forced her to bear his children.)
- m. Chobei and Leora started to blur the lines before the root arch, but during it he became very possessive of her and where she could and couldn't go. He limited where she could be in the estate and she could not leave it. He would obsessively remove roots around the estate. He would get so territorial about her safety that it made the conflict between him and Sukuna worse.
- n. Ultimately, after she came back from death, after being in the threads for seven days, (during the Nidr arch where Nidr tried to break her) he was the only one who could speak to her and calm her down.
- o. He's the only one she told about the threads and the possibly past lives she lived in death, about the rapes, the murders, the children taken and killed, the betrayals, everything.
- p. She was so starved of affection from Sukuna that she was breaking and because she is the Alraune, Sukuna's vagueness about whether he actually loved her or not was actually killing her because he would give her just enough to think he loved her but then not give it again. (If the Alraune loves and is not loved back she dies.)
- q. Chobei kissed her after she returned from the threads for the first time and told her she deserved to be kissed and loved.
- r. That started a charged will they wont they cat and mouse relationship
- s. Now Leora has chosen Chobei and they have begun a full physical and sexually intimate relationship.
 - i. Leora has devoted a wing of the estate just to them
 - ii. Chōbei has one day set aside each week (soon to be two) where he is with leora 100% alone
 - iii. There are no servants. They lives as normal people when they are together and they isolate themselves completely.

- t. Leora's feelings for Chōbei have only deepened seeing him as a father and the way he treats her son (Tsukihiko) is exactly the way she thinks love should be shown and the way she always wanted to be treated by someone.
- u. Chōbei and Leora have an extremely emotionally and physically charged relationship. They are intimate often and very affectionate, especially alone. They seek comfort through grounding.
- v. Chōbei is tender with her in ways he never allows himself to be outside of Tsukihiko.
- w. Leora has now had times where her body has been violated in ways and she always comes to Chōbei to heal through physical intimacy because "if something is wrong, Sukuna would blame himself. But you would hold me while I cried."
- x. Chobei earned Sukuna's trust and respect when Chobei began removing/killing servants and guards who thought that "sukuna's absence created opportunity"
 - i. One morning, a servant openly leered at Leora as she lay unclothed in bed with Chobei. Chobei nearly killed him. Sukuna came and agreed with the punishment.
 - ii. Another man thought he could come into Leora's private chambers and touch her things. He removed him.
 - iii. Two men were caught plotting how they would assault Leora, Kiyomi, and Kaguya. He killed them.
 - iv. Two other men went so far as to actually set their plan in motion to corner Leora and Kaguya at the onsen and take advantage of them. He killed them.
 - v. The last man cut some of Leora's hair (her most adored feature by the men in her life) and Chobei's slow, sadistic killing of him actually caught Sukuna's attention and he helped him.

Family Blood

Blood family members:

1. Sukuna (father) + Leora (mother) = Tsukihiko, Mizuki, Kaguya, Kurohiko, Higan (siblings)
2. Chobei and Toma (brothers)
3. Leora (sister) and Friedhelm (brother)
4. Kiyomi (sister) and Sieg (brother)
5. Kohaku ("Kiba") and Freyr = sons of Chobei and Tsukihiko. Kohaku is blessed by Skugga and has fox yokai traits and Freyr was made by Wulf with the blessing of Vargr and has Wolf yokai traits
6. Linnea (daughter of Toma and Kaguya/ blessed by the deity Vallraun)

Underwent the Immortality ritual:

1. Leora
2. Friedhelm
3. Toma (in future)
4. Chobei (in future)
5. Kiyomi (possible future)
6. Sieg (possible future)

Married-Into Family

1. Chobei performed the devouring vow with Tsukihiko which is more binding than marriage.
2. Toma (Chōbei's younger beloved brother) and Kaguya (Leora and Sukuna's only daughter / Sukuna's favorite)
3. Kurohiko and Kiyomi (will be married)
4. Sieg (brother of kiyomi and will call calls Kurohiko Otōsan)
5. Kyrr performed the Devouring Vow with Mizuki

Grandchildren of Sukuna and Leora:

1. Kohaku (Oldest son of Tsukihiko and Chōbei)
2. Freyr (Youngest son of Tsukihiko and Chōbei)
3. Linnea (Daughter of Tōma and Kaguya)
4. Sieg Adopted grandson after Kurohiko's marriage to his sister Kiyomi

Special note:

1. Higan is Leora and Sukuna's three year old son